

"Rather than treating trends as surface aesthetics, ColourNext 2026 approaches them as cultural movements—systems of thought, behaviour, and imagination that shape how the world is being rebuilt."

AMIT SYNGLE
MD and CEO of Asian Paints Ltd



but about grounding ourselves more deeply within it.

For those drawn to heritage, Pastoral redefines luxury through lineage, locality and inherited craft, proving that in an age of digital impersonation, ancestral knowledge, and land memory are the true markers of value. Finally, Daydream offers a soft suspension of time, creating a quietly surreal environment where the mind overlays reality with poetry, emotion, and light. Home becomes a sanctuary.

Wall-to-Wall Wonder

Extending the narrative of quiet depth is the Wallpaper of the Year 2026, Zanskar. Inspired by the high-altitude landscapes of the Himalayas, this design weaves a trellis of blooming roses across the surface, drawing from the intricate language of traditional pastoral embroidery. Hand-block printed gilver details shimmer softly like moonlight on mountain ridges, adding a subtle luminosity to any room. Both grounded and intricate, Zanskar reflects a renewed appreciation for craft and provenance, ensuring that the stories of our ancestors continue to have a place within the modern home.

Innovation is Key

This year also marks the introduction of the ColourNext Lab, a dedicated platform for material research and experimentation that prioritises curiosity over ready-made solutions. The Lab explores how colour and material intelligence can take many shapes, from heritage conservation and palettes for historic cities to experimental surfaces and spatial frameworks. Rooted in months of hands-on inquiry, the Lab reflects Asian Paints' commitment to research-led innovation, offering a limited-edition range of experimental finishes that explore what materials might become. Together, these directions signal a deeper cultural shift from spectacle to meaning, offering a future-facing framework for the worlds we will inhabit next.